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Assignment 1

Bad interface: Dishwasher at my apartment

The dishwasher in my apartment is a clear example of a bad interface. Its control panel and display are located inside the door, so when the dishwasher is closed, you cannot see how much time is left. In a noisy kitchen, it is also difficult to tell whether it is running, especially when the washing machine is on at the same time as the dishwasher. The door does not lock automatically while the dishwasher is operating. This increases the risk of accidentally opening it which could damage the machine. Overall, using this dishwasher is frustrating, inefficient, and prone to errors. From a usability perspective, effectiveness, efficiency, and user satisfaction are low. It is not easy to check the dishwasher's status or operate it. Improvements could be for example to move the display and basic status indicators (e.g., remaining time, program progress) to the outside of the door. Also another possible suggestion is to include a locking mechanism that engages while the dishwasher is running. Also it could be possible to add auditory or visual feedback to indicate when the machine is operating.



front door dishwasher



control panel

Good interface: instant noodles in a heat-resistant cup

A good interface example of user-friendly design is instant noodles in a heat-resistant cup such as OYAKATA instant noodles cup. You can add hot water directly into the cup and eat from it without needing a plate or cover. You pour boiling water into the cup, wait a few minutes, then drain it through the holes in the lid. The design shows clear affordances, such as the holes indicating where the water will go, and the cup itself being ready for eating. Overall, this interface is easy to learn, efficient, and satisfying. Users can complete the task quickly with minimal effort, the risk of errors is very low, and it is memorable for repeated use. According to ISO 9241, which was discussed in the lecture, this example meets usability attributes: effectiveness (task can be completed), efficiency (fast and simple), satisfaction (pleasant to use), low error rate, and good memorability.

